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"They're Like Slash": Multimodality and Embodied Agency in Students' Critical Engagements with Texts

María José Aragón
Department of Education Studies, University of California, San Diego, San Diego, CA, USA

Meghan Corella
Department of Language and Literacy Education, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC, Canada

Nora W. Lang
Department of Teacher Education, San José State University, San Jose, CA, USA

ABSTRACT

Despite recent calls to more fully incorporate multimodal perspectives into literacies research, there is still limited scholarship examining how students critically engage in reading activities by drawing on embodied practices. Racially and linguistically minoritized students are particularly disadvantaged by dominant logocentric and developmentalist approaches, which privilege oral and written discourse and often position these students as less capable of performing complex literacy practices. Drawing from three independent ethnographic studies, our multimodal interactional analysis examines how students of a range of ages and raciolinguistic backgrounds use embodied actions and other semiotic resources to agentively navigate text, task, and ideological constraints in activities involving reading and analyzing texts. Our analysis demonstrates the crucial role of students' embodied practices in expanding upon and challenging the constraints of literacy activities, focusing particularly on how students leveraged epistemic stance-taking, embodied affective responses, and embodied forms of argumentation to negotiate and co-construct meaning. Through a focus on embodied agency, this paper presents and applies an interactional perspective on the embodied nature of literacy activities; shows how students' creative mobilizations of embodied and other semiotic resources contribute to their critical readings of texts; and offers pedagogical and methodological implications for ways educators and researchers can attend to the intricacies of students' embodied sense-making in literacy activities.

Introduction

Until the quite recent embodied turn (Hillesund et al., 2022; Nevile, 2015), most literacies research has only marginally attended to the agentive, nuanced ways young people use embodied actions as semiotic resources for reading and analyzing texts. Cognitivist and Cartesian views of reading remain pervasive within literacies pedagogies, research, and public discourse, reinforcing a view of reading as a disembodied activity (see, e.g., Lenters & McDermott, 2019). To be sure, the marginalization of embodiment is not unique to literacies research. Indeed, logocentric views of embodiment as merely supplemental to language (Bucholtz & Hall, 2016), together with human exceptionalist views linking embodied action to the animal body (Goldstein & Hall, 2021) and developmentalist discourses linking bodily control to the normative adult body (Liddiard & Slater, 2018; Lupton, 2013), have shaped much research and practice in language and literacy education more generally. Literacies researchers seeking to trouble these discourses have attended to embodiment through a variety of approaches, including multiliteracies (New London Group, 1996; Street et al., 2009) and multimodality (Jewitt, 2008; Jewitt & Kress, 2003; Kress, 2009), embodied literacies (e.g., González Ybarra & Saavedra, 2021; Thiel, 2015), racial literacy (e.g., Ohito, 2022), and

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ethnographically informed discourse analysis (e.g., Johnson, 2017; Kyratzis, 2017). Even within these areas, however, few studies have adopted an interactional approach centered on how children and young people agentively mobilize embodied resources (e.g., gestures, eye gaze, facial expressions, posture, bodily orientation) to read and interpret texts within local ecologies of power and identity.

Drawing from three independent ethnographic studies, our multimodal interactional analysis examines how students across three classrooms used embodied actions and other semiotic resources (e.g., spoken language, images, written texts, classroom configurations) to agentively navigate text, task, and ideological constraints in the context of literacy activities involving reading and analyzing text. More specifically, we focus on racially and linguistically minoritized students[1], who are racialized through processes associated with the "historical and contemporary co-naturalization of language and race" (Rosa & Flores, 2017, p. 622) and are particularly disadvantaged by interlocking logocentric, developmentalist, and raciolinguistic ideologies (Costa-Carvalho, 2023; Flores & Rosa, 2015; Mills & LeFrançois, 2018; Rosa & Flores, 2017). Our analysis demonstrates the crucial role of students' embodied practices in expanding upon and challenging the constraints of literacy activities, focusing particularly on how students leveraged epistemic stance-taking, embodied affective responses, and embodied forms of argumentation to negotiate and co-construct meaning. We show how students steered literacy activities in directions they found meaningful by mobilizing embodied and other semiotic resources in ways that ultimately enriched opportunities for sense-making. From a pedagogical standpoint, our analysis suggests that a narrow, logocentric focus on verbal contributions may lead teachers to dismiss students' embodied actions as irrelevant or "off-task," rather than central to students' agentive sense-making and reflective of their engagement in critical literacy practices. Methodologically, we argue that an interactional approach to examining students' creative mobilization of embodied resources presents unique affordances for capturing the complexities of making sense of texts, particularly for racially and linguistically minoritized students, who are often positioned as incapable of performing complex literacy practices.

Overall, through a focus on the embodied agency (Bucholtz & Hall, 2016) on display within complex multimodal gestalts (Mondada, 2014), this paper presents and applies an interactional perspective on the embodied nature of literacy activities; shows how students' creative mobilizations of embodied and other semiotic resources contribute to their critical readings of texts as well as their constructions of relationships with one another; and offers pedagogical and methodological implications for ways educators and researchers can attend to the intricacies of students' embodied sense-making in literacy activities. In the next section, we contextualize our analysis by discussing relevant literature, focusing especially on multimodal discourse analytic research that captures the nuances of the turn-by-turn unfolding of young people's use of embodied resources in literacy activities.

Relevant Literature: Multimodality, Embodiment, and Literacies

For several decades, scholars within the fields of language and literacy(ies), sociolinguistics, and multimodality have explored the role of multimodal and embodied resources (e.g., gaze, hand gestures, posture) in social interaction, arguing that the separation of language from other dimensions of human communication is illogical (Goodwin, 2000; Halliday, 1994; Mondada, 2014; van Leeuwen, 2005). Work in this vein has shown embodied actions, in conjunction with other semiotic resources (e.g., spoken language, images, print texts, spatial configuration of the material environment), are central rather than merely supplemental to interaction, partly because of the specific affordances of particular modes for meaning making. For example, as Goodwin and Cekaite (2013) show, facial expressions, touch, and other embodied actions have a more enduring temporal quality than speech. Similarly, Andries et al. (2023) discuss how embodied resources allow for synchronization of stance expressions. Given these and other interactionally emergent affordances, even seemingly minute embodied actions, both in coordination with speech and on their own, are significant resources for accomplishing social action. These insights have been taken up in various areas of scholarship, particularly in the cognitive and learning sciences, where there is a focus on the relationship between embodied actions, such as gestures and body movements, and students' learning in particular domains (see, e.g., DeLiema et al., 2021). Recognizing the lack of dialogue between literature focused on gesture, signs, and multimodality on the one hand, and the large body of research examining bi/multilingual language practices (Block, 2013; Kusters et al., 2017) on the other hand, various researchers studying multilingual contexts have emphasized the inherent entanglement of linguistic and other semiotic resources (Hawkins, 2019; Li & Lin, 2019; Pennycook, 2017) and explored opportunities afforded by specific modes, such as digital resources, for sense-making and accessing content (e.g., Pacheco & Smith, 2015; Yi, 2014).

Literacies research focused specifically on reading has taken up these multimodal perspectives in a range of ways in relation to embodiment. Broadly speaking, one line of inquiry, informed by developmental and psychological perspectives, has investigated pedagogical questions, including how embodied versus solely text-based

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approaches to reading instruction affect story recall (e.g., Marley et al., 2010) and how teachers' gestures may support students' vocabulary development (e.g., Barnes et al., 2023) and narrative comprehension (e.g., Gámez et al., 2017). While such research sheds light on the utility of embodied resources for reading, it generally overlooks student agency and frames embodiment as merely a form of support for acquiring language. By contrast, reading research informed by multimodal, sociolinguistic, and other discourse analytic perspectives views embodied resources as valuable and complex in their own right and positions students as agentive. This work explores questions such as how students multimodally socialize one another into reading practices (e.g., Johnson, 2017; Kyratzis, 2017) and how embodied resources are used by teachers and students alike in multidirectional literacy socialization practices (e.g., Cekaite & Björk-Willén, 2018). In these studies, embodied resources are central to a range of social actions necessary for reading, such as establishing intersubjectivity and building relationships (Johnson, 2017), socializing readers into valorized stances, identities, and values (Cekaite & Björk-Willén, 2018; Johnson, 2017; Kyratzis, 2017; Oliveira & Barnes, 2019), and co-constructing new or alternative stories, interpretations, and discourses (Heller, 2019; Kontovourki & Siegel, 2021; Lewis, 2020).

Particularly relevant to the present analysis are multimodal interactional analyses showing how readers' agentive mobilization of embodied resources contributes in important ways to their complex meaning-making practices—even for very young children, and even in the face of logocentric assumptions and other interactional constraints. For example, in Heller's (2019) multimodal analysis of mother–child picture book interactions, a 19-month-old German child mobilized deictic gestures, depictive gestures, bodily alignments, and other semiotic resources to construct a story involving displacements of person and space that were more complex than the discourse solicited by the mother's display questions and the book's static representations of objects. Young readers' embodied agency is likewise visible in Cekaite and Björk-Willén's (2018) multimodal interactional analysis of how teachers' multimodal strategies not only shaped students' actions, but how children's embodied affective stances (e.g., a "scared" facial expression) shaped teachers' actions in that they were often recycled or otherwise ratified by teachers. Similarly, the US kindergarteners in Johnson's (2017) ethnography shaped one another's literacy socialization through the strategic ways they extended teachers' practices, including using embodied directives (e.g., shoving a book in an inattentive peer's face) to create accountable participation frameworks during peer reading. Kyratzis (2017) likewise examines peer reading activities, showing how the forms of peer social organization that are highly motivational to young readers are co-constructed by her bilingual Mexican American preschool participants, whose mutually accountable intercorporeal participation frameworks relied on a range of multimodal resources, including multiple languages, environmentally coupled gestures, perceptual directives, and embodied affect displays.

While these studies are invaluable for understanding the thoroughly embodied nature of reading practices, they do not typically focus specifically on issues of agency, power, or identity, and they tend to focus on early childhood education. In this analysis, then, we place these issues at the center of our analysis of readers of a range of ages and raciolinguistic backgrounds, asking: How do focal students use embodied actions and other semiotic resources to agentively navigate constraints within the context of literacy activities? In order to make sense of how students within each classroom navigate these constraints as they engage in and creatively expand upon literacy activities, we contend that it is essential to consider micro-level features of their literacy practices within the context of power dynamics that shape how they interact with one another and with local curricula and instruction. In the next section, we describe the theoretical perspectives that guide our integration of this range of considerations into our analysis.

Theoretical Framework: Conceptualizing Embodied Agency in Literacy Interactions

While a view of literacies as embodied has increasingly been adopted within some areas of literacies research, given the gaps in the literature discussed above—particularly the relative inattention to student agency and its interactionally contingent nature—the framework of this study draws primarily on embodied agency as it has been theorized in sociocultural linguistics. Bucholtz and Hall (2016) note that embodied action has been largely neglected in sociolinguistic research and has primarily been understood "as secondary to language rather than as the sine qua non of language" (p. 174). Taking an expansive interdisciplinary perspective, Bucholtz and Hall (2016) argue that even unmarked phenomena (e.g., gaze, gesture) are "imbued with social meaning" (p. 186) and not only communicate meaning in conjunction with spoken discourse but can perform social action powerfully and independently of talk (e.g., Haddington et al., 2013; Streeck et al., 2011). In line with this perspective, we consider embodied actions to be part of a broader system of semiotic practices, which also includes the use of written and spoken language and other material resources used to communicate and negotiate meaning within social contexts. These semiotic modes interact in complex ways and

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often involve the simultaneous deployment of embodied actions in coordination with oral language and other semiotic resources (e.g., Goodwin, 2000; Mondada, 2014).

A focus on embodied agency goes hand in hand with attention to how affects are mobilized and communicated through embodied action in the context of social interaction. Despite a growing interest in the relationship between affect and embodiment in linguistics, literacies, and other related fields, relatively little scholarship has addressed how affects circulate in and through discourse (Milani & Richardson, 2021, p. 675). Interactional perspectives are crucial to addressing these issues, and our theorization of affect is therefore grounded in such perspectives. More specifically, we are guided by Kiesling's (2018) view of affects as "stimulated via moment-to-moment stance-taking in conversation" (p. 201) as well as Goodwin et al.'s (2012) work on embodied affective stances as agentive public forms of action that are both responsive to prior actions and proactive in shaping next responses (pp. 38–39). Such interactional perspectives on affect contrast with still-dominant conceptualizations of emotion as located in an individual's inner state, emphasizing instead the thoroughly social and political nature of affect (see also Massumi, 2015).

With the aim of capturing how students' embodied literacy practices are central to their agentive work as readers and learners, we also foreground the role of affect in shaping how students position themselves in relation to one another and the literacy activities in which they were engaged. Here we draw on Kiesling's (2018) three-dimensional model of stance-taking as comprised of investment, evaluation, and alignment. This framework allows us to view students' engagement with literacy activities not only as narrowly tied to their successful completion of particular tasks, but rather as mediated by their embodied affective responses, which are interactionally achieved and do not rely solely on the production of oral language. For example, in their work on gender and stance-taking, Kiesling (2018) suggests that low-investment stances to conversation, associated with ease and confidence, are constitutive of hegemonic masculinity. Similarly, we describe the mediated actions through which students take affective and epistemic stances of varying degrees of investment as they (dis)align with one another, their teachers, and texts through a range of verbal and embodied actions[2].

The concept of "affective agency" has been employed by some scholars to center the role of affect in shaping social processes and structures (McManus, 2011), including shaping raciolinguistically minoritized students' learning and engagement in education contexts (Bucholtz et al., 2018; Ferrada et al., 2020). Berg and Ramos-Zayas (2015) propose the term "racialized affect" to foreground the integral role of racialization processes in upholding and producing stereotypes about how affect is manifested and circulated by racialized subjects. From a raciolinguistic perspective, Rosa and Flores (2017) have expanded their initial framing of the "white listening subject" (Flores & Rosa, 2015) to the "white perceiving subject" in order to highlight how nonverbal modes contribute to hegemonic views of "appropriate" communicative practices, particularly: "the overdetermination of various nonspoken and nonlinguistic signs associated with racialized subjects, including literacy practices, physical features, bodily comportment, and sartorial style" (Rosa & Flores, 2017, p. 629). Scholars have also argued that focusing on affect not only serves to expose the construction of difference and perceived deficiency perpetuated by the "white gaze" but is also crucial in understanding how raciolinguistic ideologies "operate on different bodies in different manners" (Lee, 2024, p. 247) and are inextricably tied to the unique lived experiences, histories, and meaning-making practices of racialized communities (see, e.g., Baker-Bell, 2020). Extending these perspectives, we consider affect to be central to the analysis of students' embodied and multimodal literacy practices.

In line with these discursive views of affect, our view of literacies is sociocultural and interactional. This interdisciplinary approach includes ethnographic studies that frame literacy as an inherently social practice (e.g., Heath, 1983), research documenting a wide range of literacy practices across diverse sociocultural contexts (e.g., Hull & Schultz, 2002; Moje, 2008), critical approaches to the study of literacy (e.g., Lewis, 2001, 2020; Luke, 2012), and research that centers the role of multimodal literacies in learning (e.g., Gee, 1996; New London Group, 1996; Street, 2003). While attempts to define literacy from these particular vantage points inevitably foreground certain dimensions over others, there is significant convergence within this "sociocultural" body of work in that they generally view literacy as "participation in a range of valued meaning-making practices…nested within particular activity structures that index desired purposes, roles and identities" (Hull & Moje, 2012, p. 52). Due to our focus on classroom discourse in the context of activities emically defined as "reading," we also draw on an interactional lens, which conceptualizes reading as a public, shared, mutually accountable, locally situated, and spatially and materially configured activity (e.g., Kyratzis, 2017). The focus on microlevel aspects of interactions within specific literacy events lends itself particularly well to examining how literacy is interactionally constructed and negotiated in the context of distinct classroom communities.

Methodology

The data described here were gathered as part of three larger independent studies, all of which involved ethnographic inquiry into classroom-based interaction. Here,

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we draw on multimodal interaction analysis (Norris, 2004, 2011) in conjunction with an embodied approach to sociocultural linguistics (Bucholtz & Hall, 2008, 2016) to explore students' meaning-making as they engaged in literacy activities, with a particular emphasis on students' multimodal stance-taking (Kiesling, 2018).

Multimodal interaction analysis, Norris (2020) explains, emerged out of efforts to create a methodological framework that could allow for the integration of datasets that included language, video, and physical objects, among other sources, without separating the multitude of actions deployed by social actors. Put simply, multimodal interaction analysis allows for exploration into how people interact with one another using language and other semiotic systems, as well as with physical, social, and digital aspects of their environment. From this perspective, social actors produce cultural tools (languages, stools, video games, etc.), and simultaneously create and re-imagine those tools through their use (Norris, 2020). We found multimodal interaction analysis helpful in conceptualizing how lower-level mediated actions, such as a single gesture, fit within higher-level mediated actions, such as a conversation. We also relied on insights from embodied approaches to sociocultural linguistics that emphasize the importance of local categories of identity and the need for ethnographic perspectives in order to understand those categories (Bucholtz & Hall, 2008).

Participants and Settings

We present a comparative analysis of interactions surrounding literacy activities in three classrooms, at three different grade levels (second, sixth, and eleventh), within public schools in California. All three classrooms were comprised of a majority of students who were racialized, many of whom were multilingual. The three datasets were collected between 2015 and 2019 and were thus situated squarely within the first several years of implementing the Common Core State Standards (CCSS) in California. The CCSS have been characterized as "the centre-point of neoliberal reforms in the United States" (Brass, 2014, p. 127) and have been critiqued for their marginalization of sociocultural context and students' funds of knowledge (see, e.g., Eppley, 2015). However, as we will explain below, the local ecologies varied significantly across the three classrooms, including the teachers' identities and approaches to literacy instruction (e.g., the degree to which they oriented to the CCSS in their practices) as well as students' raciolinguistic identities and educational backgrounds. For the sake of readability, we provide additional ethnographic information about the classrooms, participants, and our positionalities in conjunction with excerpts from each classroom in the Findings section below.

It is important to note that our comparison of classrooms is not intended to link particular embodied practices to particular grade levels, age groups, or raciolinguistic identities. Rather, like others who have compared embodied literacy practices across different schools (e.g., Oliveira & Barnes, 2019) and even different nation-states (e.g., Bateman & Cekaite, 2022), by juxtaposing interactions from three different classrooms, we aim to illustrate a broader range of students, pedagogical practices, text types, literacy activities, and embodied actions than can be observed in one classroom alone. While in our analysis we have chosen to highlight a subset of salient practices for each classroom to facilitate readability, we do not intend to suggest that these practices were exclusive to each context. This comparative approach is also useful for illustrating how participants' use of embodied actions and other semiotic resources shaped and were shaped by aspects of each ethnographic setting, including the affordances and constraints of locally relevant language and literacy policies and practices, as we demonstrate below.

Data Collection and Analysis

We draw primarily from video recordings of student interaction and ethnographic fieldnotes gathered in the three classrooms. The three larger ethnographic studies from which we draw here explored classroom-based interaction in the context of language and literacy activities but were not explicitly focused on embodied actions. For each dataset (300 hours for classroom 1, 80 hours for classroom 2, and 40 hours for classroom 3), we individually reviewed data logs, codes, and transcripts to identify group interactions during activities emically referred to as "reading"—that is, during literacy activities involving students reading and analyzing texts (e.g., prereading predictions, discussion during group reading, close analysis of text). Given our interest in the embodied and agentive ways students engaged with written texts, for this analysis, each author selected interactions during reading activities from the larger datasets that were illustrative of a range of ways in which students mobilized embodied resources to expand on the activities as they had been presented, and that highlight some of the constraints that shaped their interactions. We individually and then collectively analyzed interactions in which students actively challenged dominant interpretations of texts, paying particular attention to their embodied actions. This process involved engaging in virtual data sessions, where we shared and collaboratively analyzed video excerpts and transcripts and presented and discussed our preliminary interactional analyses. While the central role of students' embodied actions in expanding upon and challenging the constraints of literacy activities is particularly apparent in the interactions described below, evidence of students' embodied and multimodal sense-making was present within students' interactions during other literacy activities across all three datasets.

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The selected transcripts illustrate various participant structures, including teacher-led whole-class discussion, teacher- or researcher-facilitated small group discussion, and student-led discussion. While the extent to which the texts were overtly framed by teachers as addressing sociopolitical issues varied, in each example, students critically negotiated and, in some instances, contested the interpretations of texts presented or ratified by their teachers. In selecting examples representing a range of participant structures and student positionings, we hope to shed light on both the "fixity and instability" of classroom-based literacy and multimodal sense-making (Kontovourki & Siegel, 2021, p. 118). Put differently, we are interested in the text, task, and ideological constraints on students' sense-making, as well as the generative possibilities that emerged through their embodied actions.

Accordingly, our approach to transcription, representation, and analysis is multimodal. We analyze the examples with an eye to how all semiotic resources work together as part of a *complex multimodal gestalt* (Mondada, 2014). Rather than considering multimodality to be the sequential deployment of semiotic resources, this construct, Mondada (2014) explains, allows the researcher to explore the "web of resources formatting an action" and to evaluate which resources are particularly important in the context of the situated activity (p. 139).[3] Notably, however, capturing a complex array of embodied and linguistic resources deployed simultaneously presents a number of challenges, including but not limited to transcription (Mondada, 2014; Nevile, 2015). As Nevile (2015) points out, there is no universally agreed-upon format for transcribing embodiment. In an effort to depict the gestalt, we created transcripts that include written descriptions of verbal and embodied resources as well as still images, where relevant and available. As Kyratzis (2017) explains, transcripts with images rather than linguistic descriptions alone are "essential for capturing the diverse and subtle ways in which children use their bodies and the material environment to accomplish relevant action and organize the doing of reading as a public and shared activity" (p. 18). For the sake of anonymity, we converted still images to line drawings. Here, we reduced the number of line drawings to facilitate readability and to provide a fine-grained analysis of a select few images from each dataset (see also Goodwin et al., 2012).

Findings

In the examples that follow, we trace how raciolinguistically minioritized youth in three different classrooms navigated a range of ideological, task-based, and material constraints as they leveraged embodied resources to engage in and expand upon literacy tasks. Students in each classroom found themselves in spaces where there were clear expectations about performing literacy in ways that aligned with successfully "doing school" (Dyson, 1984). While the specific activities students engaged in across the contexts varied in the degree to which teachers centered students' perspectives and lived experiences, activities largely privileged standards-based skills and narrow, autonomous (Street, 1984) conceptualizations of literacy. In terms of students' participation, there were a range of constraints surrounding the practices that were modeled and ratified by teachers, as well as the opportunities available to demonstrate engagement and expertise through embodied and multimodal resources. In spite of these limitations, students engaged agentively by steering the literacy activities in directions they found meaningful. As they did so, they both built on and contested each other's contributions through a range of verbal and embodied actions in ways that ultimately enriched and expanded opportunities for sense-making. In our analysis, we highlight embodied actions that are salient within complex multimodal gestalts in each context, focusing particularly on three practices: how students multimodally constructed epistemically authoritative stances as they shared their knowledge and ratified one another's knowledge, even when this knowledge was only minimally ratified by adults; how they embodied their affective responses and introduced alternative modes for making-sense of and engaging with text; and how they utilized embodied resources to negotiate disparate perspectives as they co-constructed meaning.

Classroom 1: (Co-)constructing Epistemically Authoritative Stances in Discussions of Racial Identities and Antiracism in a Second-Grade Classroom

The first dataset is drawn from a larger academic language study conducted from 2014 to 2015 by Meghan (Author 2) in Room Z, a second-grade classroom at Beachside Elementary School. Beachside is located in a suburban area near a mid-sized California city. During the 2014–15 school year, Room Z's students roughly reflected the linguistic and ethnoracial demographics of the school as a whole: with regard to linguistic backgrounds, nine of Room Z's 21 students were designated English Learners, and with regard to ethnoracial identities, 10 students were Latinx, five were White, one was Latinx and White, one was Mexican and Italian, one was Indian American, one was Arab American, one was African American, and one was Filipino American. Their teacher, Ms. Morris, was a well-liked middle-class White woman with over a decade

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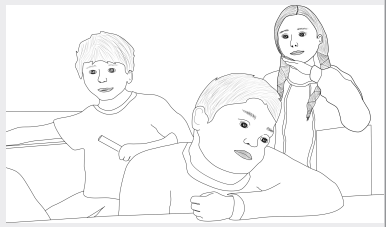
of teaching experience. Meghan, who identifies as a middle-class White Jewish woman, volunteered in the classroom from 2013 to 2016. During the 2014–15 academic year, she visited the classroom 2 to 4 days per week as a classroom volunteer and researcher, supporting students and Ms. Morris with academic tasks and social interactions while audio- and video-recording approximately 300 hours of classroom interactions and ethnographic interviews and collecting copies of student work and other classroom texts. The 2014–2015 school year was the first year of Beachside's full implementation of the CCSS, and Ms. Morris's language and literacy instructional practices thus tended to be organized around CCSS practices and foci, such as academic language and close reading of informational texts, as will be exemplified by the below excerpts.

The excerpts analyzed in this section, drawn from a January 2015 discussion of a Martin Luther King Junior text in Ms. Morris's second-grade classroom at Beachside Elementary, illustrate how students' embodied actions served as crucial resources for positioning themselves and one another as epistemically authoritative as they co-constructed sociopolitically sophisticated understandings of the text's key terms and ideas. The complexity of their jointly constructed interpretations is particularly salient given local constraints, including material constraints (e.g., a teacher-fronted seating arrangement), linguistic constraints (e.g., unfamiliar and often abstract lexical items in the focal text), and ideological constraints, particularly developmentalist surveillance of children's embodied actions (see Corella, 2022), logocentric assumptions about literacy, and White interpretations of racial identities and anti-racist practices.

Prior to the below exchanges, the students had read an informational text about Dr. King's activism and life in pairs. Although the text included several photos of King, the overall focus of the prereading pair work—like the postreading discussions represented in the below transcripts—was quite logocentric in that students' main task was to underline unfamiliar and/or important words. Following this pair work, Ms. Morris had the whole group re-read the text, calling on students to popcorn read one or two sentences aloud and pausing after each student's turn so the group could jointly identify and define keywords and phrases. As Example 1 below begins, the group has just encountered the term "African American" in the text, and Ms. Morris is calling on students with raised hands, beginning with Latina student Camila. Below, Camila's use of embodied resources in her multimodal turn helps to position her as epistemically authoritative about ethnoracial identity, and it also serves to momentarily expand the discussion beyond the relatively narrow range of identities highlighted by the text and Ms. Morris's presentation of it:

Excerpt 1

	Actor	Verbal actions	Embodied actions (images where relevant & available)
1	MS MORRIS;	Camila?	
2	CAMILA;	They're like slash. They're like half African and half American.	Moves left hand diagonally, forming a slash-like gesture  *Figure 1*
3	MS MORRIS;	mm- they are American. (1.0) And, it has something to do with Africa and America (.).	

In response to Ms. Morris's invitation to define "African American" (line 1), Camila takes an invested and epistemically authoritative stance as she describes African Americans as "like slash," holding up her left hand diagonally in an iconic gesture (McNeill, 1992) resembling a written forward slash (line 2; Figure 1). Although Camila's definition of "African American" is non-standard and suggests she needs some support with understanding the meaning of the term (which Ms. Morris begins to provide in line 3), her manual gesture helps to construct her as knowledgeable in that it both clarifies and highlights her verbal depiction of African Americans as "like slash." As a whole, the gesture–speech gestalt suggests a sophisticated awareness of discourses surrounding so-called "hyphenated" identities and of the marked punctuation conventions with which they are often represented in standardized language. Her awareness of these social and linguistic nuances may have been shaped by her identity as a Latina raised in the United States by immigrant parents as well as by her local identity as an avid reader and as a Room Z "challengers" student (these were students positioned as "advanced" within this classroom's marked ability grouping system; see Corella, 2020 for details). Yet perhaps unsurprisingly given the marginalization of sociopolitical context and students' funds of knowledge within the close reading pedagogies encouraged by the CCSS (see, e.g., Aragón, 2022), the teacher does not build on this notion of hyphenated identities, instead ultimately defining African Americans as American citizens with family from Africa and pursuing a return to the text.

However, as the activity continues, other students likewise draw on their knowledge and personal experiences as

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they construct multimodal gestalts that trouble the otherwise relatively depoliticized discussion of the MLK text. About 10 minutes after the exchange in Example 1, the group encounters another key vocabulary item: "marches." As the group discusses the term, the teacher verbally defines marches in terms of (dis)agreements with laws, and at one point in the conversation (not transcribed here for reasons of space, but see Figure 2 below), she gesturally performs a well-reasoned stance through an embodied display of "doing thinking" (see Heller, 2021).

Figure 2

In the interaction that follows, this affectively distant stance comes to contrast with the intensely conflictual, highly affectively invested stances highlighted by several students—all students of color—in a sequence in which they ratify one another's epistemic authority and build on one another's ideas. This exchange unfolds following a question from Meghan about students' knowledge of marches and protests occurring at the time (see lines 1–3 below), including Black Lives Matter marches, which had been quite visible in the media in the preceding months following Michael Brown's murder by police and the Ferguson uprising:

As in Example 1, here, several racialized students position themselves as invested in and knowledgeable about the sociopolitically complex topic at hand, relating it to their own experiences through their embodied participation in the discussion. Their investment in discussing the news speaks to affective dimensions of racial literacy (Ohito, 2022) and is conveyed in a range of ways, including through enthusiastic hand raises by six students of color (line 2) and through more complex multimodal contributions to the conversation. Their investment contrasts with the teacher's; rather than investing in expanding the conversation, Ms. Morris invests in redirecting the discussion back to the text ("we won't get into it now," line 16; "let's keep reading," line 24). Yet, even in the face of these attempts to redirect the conversation, several students manage to introduce new ideas and to expand the range of meanings and affects associated with the term "march." For instance, Amelia, a student of color[4], highlights emotionally charged, conflictual affects, such as "fighting" and "yelling out stuff" (lines 9–11), whereupon Ms. Morris asks students to return to the text and highlight the word "peaceful" (line 12), then characterizes some recent marches as not peaceful (line 16). While Ms. Morris's turn partially ratifies Amelia's knowledge, it also stops short of more deeply exploring it.

However, Tessa, another student of color, builds on her friend Amelia's affectively expanded definition of "marches" by sharing her knowledge in a sequence in which she likewise points to conflictual affects, using both hands to iconically represent a gap (see Figure 3) as she verbally describes a "big gap" between Black and White protestors (lines 17–19). Tessa's "gap" gestures not only visually represent the term's meaning in a way that may be useful to English learners or other peers unfamiliar with (this sense of) the word (e.g., Gámez et al., 2017), but they also position her as highly invested in the conversation, particularly since she repeats the gesture and performs it in coordination with her verbal actions. Furthermore, much like other young readers' use of representational gestures during storytelling (e.g., Heller, 2019), this multimodal gestalt helps emphasize the story's tellability, and significantly, of the tellability of a story revolving around embodiment (i.e., here, a story about the meanings of gaps between differently racialized bodies). Ms. Morris's polite assessment of Tessa's contribution as "interesting" and her statement that she has not seen the event in question (line 20) reflect text-centric CCSS pedagogies as well as colorblind (Bonilla-Silva, 2002) and colormute (Bucholtz, 2019; Pollock, 2004) discourses, and Meghan's markedly hedged alignment with Tessa (line 22) does little to unsettle these discourses. In this context, it is particularly important that Daniel (who was on friendly terms with Tessa but not a close friend) ratifies the accuracy and tellability of Tessa's "gap" story. Despite the ideological constraints of White discourse and the embodied constraints of the classroom seating arrangement (he is seated in front of Tessa, his back toward her chair), he nonetheless engages with his peer, working to establish a partial facing-formation (Kendon, 1990) by turning in his chair and directing his gaze at Tessa. As he does so, he repurposes the highlighter in his hand to form a deictic gesture directed at her (see Figure 4), and he states that he has seen "it," with the pronoun working to further frame the stance object as shared, and with the overlapping speech of his utterance heightening his investment (line 23). Though fleeting, this affiliative display of affect (Cekaite & Björk-Willén, 2018; Heller, 2019) and ratification of Tessa's knowledge illustrates how reading interactions are important for both peer relationship building and literacy learning, a point on which we expand in the Discussion section.

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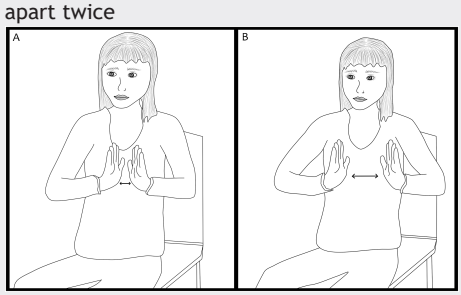
Excerpt 2

1	MEGHAN;	Oh I was just gonna ask room Z if they've heard about marches or protests on the news lately?	
2	OLIVER, DANIEL, CAMILA, GABRIELA, CARA, ANNALISE;		Raising hands
3	MEGHAN;	Does anyone watch the news? Yeah, some people have [seen marches?]	
4	MS MORRIS;	[Okay, does] anyone know what those marches or protests have been about?	
5	#AMELIA;	#sometimes I #do <softly>	Embodied actions not visible as she is off camera
6	MS MORRIS;	Do you think you know what they've been about, Amelia?	
7	AMELIA;	Uh:, I think so.	
8	MS MORRIS;	Tell us.	
9	AMELIA;	Well, (.) there was like a lot of people like fighting, and stuff? And they like, (.) held up signs and (.) they were walking #all #over #the #place,	
10	MS MORRIS;	O-	
11	AMELIA;	And they were like yelling out stuff.	
12	MS MORRIS;	Okay so in this sentence, it says "he led <u>peaceful</u>," and I'm gonna have you highlight the word "peaceful," and then "marches." (0.5)	
13	VARIOUS STUDENTS;		Marking worksheets with highlighters
14	MS MORRIS;	And what you're talking about, (.) some of these marches, or protests,	
15	TESSA;		Raises hand
16	MS MORRIS;	have <u>not</u> been peaceful. In the news. Lately. (1.5). And they actually (.) can kind of be related to Dr. @ Martin Luther King. So, (.) we won't get into it now, but these kinds of things <u>still</u> happen. People still protest things, or (.) march for or march against things. Tessa?	
17	TESSA;	Someti- one-, (.) on the news I saw, I saw, um (.), some, the African Americans on the end and the White people at the front, and they were marching, but with a big gap in the middle.	While saying "big gap," makes gap-like gesture with hands, moving hands together and then apart twice  *Figure 3*
18	MS MORRIS;	Hm. (1.5) Okay:. So I wonder if they were marching together, or if they were marching=?	
19	TESSA;	=they had a big gap and t- two different leaders. With a White leader and with an African American [leader.]	Makes gap gesture again while saying "big gap," similar to Figure 3 above

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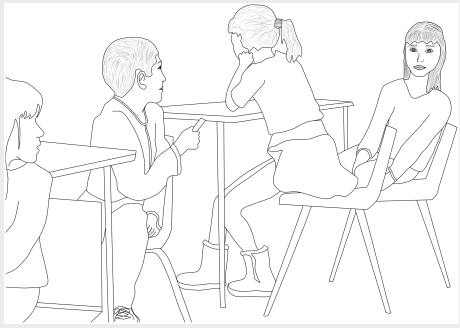
20	MS MORRIS;	[interesting,] I didn't see that one. Did you see that one?	Looking at Meghan
21	DANIEL;	###.	Turns around in chair and looks at Tessa as he verbally addresses her
22	MEGHAN;	Maybe, maybe we saw the same one. I've seen something sort of [#similar.]	
23	DANIEL;	[I saw it.]	Still turned toward Tessa; points at her with highlighter  *Figure 4*
24	MS MORRIS;	Interesting. Alright, let's keep reading.	

Classroom 2: Embodied Affective Responses as Avenues for Joint Sense-Making in a Sixth-Grade Classroom

Data examples from the second classroom are drawn from an ethnographically informed study focused on examining literacy practices in a public school sixth-grade classroom. Students' ethnoracial backgrounds in the class were consistent with overall school demographics: one student was Asian American (Filipino), one student was mixed-race (African American/Latinx), one student was from South America, 11 were Latinx (Mexican), and nine were White (Non-Latinx). Ms. Anderson, a White veteran teacher who had been at the school for over a decade, had extensive experience teaching English Language Arts in the upper elementary grades. Instruction was largely organized around a number of grade-level projects connected to specific narrative and non-fiction texts, such as *The House on Mango Street* by Sandra Cisneros and *D'Aulaires' Book of Greek Myths*, and involved students completing booklets and assignments that focused heavily on CCSS English Language Arts standards associated with reading and analyzing a variety of complex texts. María (Author 1), who identifies as a Latinx, middle-class, bilingual woman, collected data for a 5-month period during 2016, visiting the classroom two to three times a week during English Language Arts and Academic Language Development classes. As a participant-observer and volunteer in the classroom, she worked closely with students who were emergent bilinguals and who were or had previously been designated "English Learners."

The examples discussed below are from a month-long English Language Arts unit on the novel *Bridge to Terabithia* (Paterson, 1977). The focus of the unit was on skills emphasized in the CCSS, including making text-based predictions, identifying cause and effect relationships, and citing evidence to support arguments. The students participating in these discussions were all from Latinx backgrounds, and the three boys who figure prominently below had recently graduated from the school's pull-out English Language Development (ELD) program. The two examples presented here illustrate the various ways in which students were making sense of the events and experiences portrayed in the novel by embodying their affective responses and by introducing alternative modes for accessing and engaging with the text. While the students' discussions unfolded in the context of narrow curricular tasks designed to support the development of specific literacy skills, with a strong emphasis on written responses, the interactions examined demonstrate how students proactively and expansively explored their ideas and reactions by drawing on a range of multimodal resources and contesting available narratives and interpretations.

During the following activity, students had been tasked with formulating predictions for the next chapter in the novel and writing them in a worksheet, which required them to state their prediction in one column and list "evidence from the text" in a separate column. As the conversation unfolds, the students' embodied actions become central to communicating their affective stances toward

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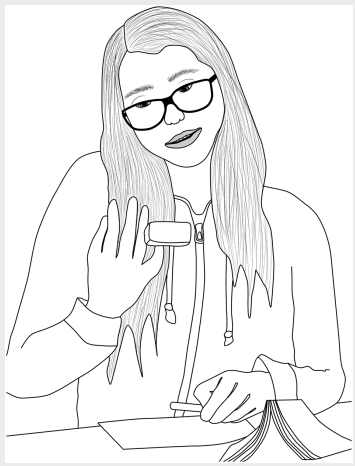
possible future events in the novel, as well as their engagement with the plot. Some students in the class, including Vanessa, had read ahead and knew that one of the main characters, Leslie, would die. Other students who had heard that a tragic incident occurred toward the end of the novel had been speculating about a possible death but were unsure about the details and circumstances surrounding the event. It is important to note that Vanessa was often

Excerpt 3

1	VANESSA;	I predict that, um, Jess is going to like, [paint] something?	
2	LUCAS;	[Die]. Ok, anyone can die but the dog.	
3	MARÍA;	You predict? Sorry, Vanessa?	
4	PEDRO;	If any- If anyone dies, I don't care, but if the dog dies,	Pretends to cry, breathing heavily *Figure 5*
5	DIEGO;	Oh my gosh, [I'm going to start crying.]	
6	VANESSA;	[That Jess is going to paint something.]	
7	MARÍA;	That he's going to paint something? Ok,	
8	VANESSA;	Because Leslie, I mean, yeah, Leslie gave him some water colors.	
9	DIEGO;	Wait. Wait. Wait.	Stretches arm out toward Vanessa
10	DIEGO;	Does the dog die?	
11	VANESSA;	I can't tell you.	Tossing her eraser up and down in her hand, shrugging  *Figure 6*

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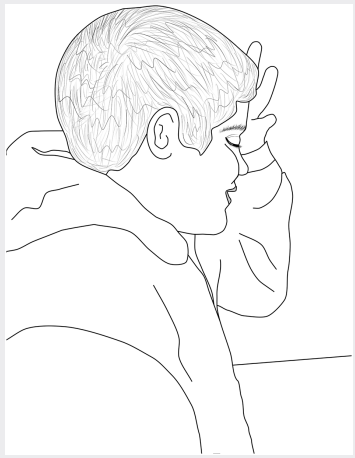
12	LUCAS;	No::	Throws head back
13	DIEGO;	Honestly, I'm going to break down.	Covers face with hand  *Figure 7*
14	PEDRO;	We want to continue right now. We want to-	
15	MARÍA;	Ok, but we need to write a prediction for Chapter 6.	
16	LUCAS;	Oh my god! What died? "No?"	
17	DIEGO;	I'm going to break down.	
18	LUCAS;	This is chapter eleven. It says "No!"	Pointing open books outwards, toward peers
19	DIEGO;	I'm going to break down.	
20	LUCAS;	Guys, Chapter 11 says, "No."	Flips through pages of book

positioned as the more expert peer in the group and most aligned with the identity of a "good student," while the boys were, at times, characterized as being "behind" and disruptive during English Language Arts projects and activities.

Here, Vanessa initiates the discussion by offering a prediction based on evidence from the text, using language that was modeled by the teacher and in classroom materials as "appropriate" for the task. She suggests that Jess would paint something because his friend, Leslie, had gifted him some watercolors (lines 1–6). In response, Lucas proposes an alternative scenario in which the dog dies (line 2), which is taken up by other peers in the group, who pursue an animated discussion about whether or not they would find it more upsetting if the dog or one of the characters in the novel died (lines 4–5, 9–13). Notably, both Diego and Pedro are quick to align with Lucas' statement by affirming that they too would be distraught by the dog's death and by embodying an emotional response. Pedro pretends to cry, closing his eyes and furrowing his forehead, while Diego covers his face with his hand, lowering it slowly as he repeatedly states that he will "break down" if the dog dies (lines 13, 17, and 19). These somewhat theatrical embodied actions contrast with Vanessa's neutral affective expression and embodied actions, which include shrugging and tossing an eraser, and which are more consistent with an emotionally distant epistemic stance (Heller, 2021). Despite the boys' enthusiasm and Pedro's request to continue reading (line 14), María does not encourage further discussion and attempts to redirect their attention to the task of filling out predictions in their worksheets. The "flow" of emotions throughout this exchange, communicated through the three boys' gestures and actions (Goodwin et al., 2012), display students' affective agency (Bucholtz et al., 2018; Ferrada et al., 2020) and challenge constraints imposed by the narrow focus of the activity, which privileges written responses based on textual evidence.

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Excerpt 4

26	LUCAS;	Oh my god guys. Look what I've just found	
27	LUCAS;	Look!	Lucas points open book toward peers; Vanessa raises eyebrows *Figure 8*
28	LUCAS;	Leslie does die.	
29	PEDRO;		Pretends to cry
30	VANESSA;	Dude.	Raises hands, then looks down
31	DIEGO;	(2.9) Oh my–	Eyes widen, mouth open *Figure 9*
32	DIEGO;		Takes book from Lucas' hands *Figure 10*

While Lucas' contribution to the discussion could be interpreted as diverging from the task at hand, his investment in the storyline grows as he searches for "clues" in the text to confirm his hypothesis that the dog might die. His facial expressions and other embodied actions communicate engagement as he holds the book close to his face and flips through the pages until he comes across the title of one of the final chapters of the book and exclaims, excitedly: "What died?" (line 16). Shortly thereafter, he encounters an image of Jess carrying Leslie in the woods and he turns the book outwards to face his peers (line 27), signaling what they should be attending to (Kyratzis, 2017) and inviting "co-participation" through his embodied actions (Johnson, 2017). Lucas' use of the text as a multimodal artifact, in which other components, such as images and titles, can provide valuable information about the sequence of events, offer him and his peers alternative avenues for sense-making compared to the narrow textual analysis required by the activity. Further, Lucas' persistence in exploring his hypothesis demonstrates his investment in the discussion and contests the narrow view of what it means to be recognized as a "literate subject" in school (Kontovourki & Siegel, 2021).

During another English Language Arts lesson, the same week, students continued to read the novel together in their groups. As Pedro is reading aloud

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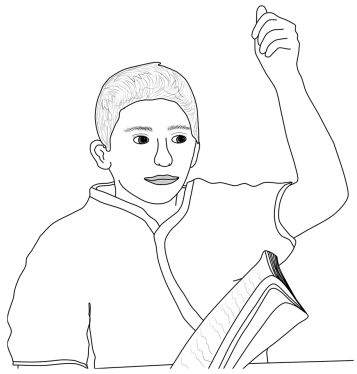
from Chapter 8, María interrupts him to ask students if they are familiar with the term "bargaining power." In the following example, Pedro's spontaneous enactment of a worker on strike expands the possible interpretations of the term beyond the experiences portrayed in the novel.

Excerpt 5

1	DIEGO;	"But Jess got the idea, It might, um, give him a little, big-"	Reading from book
2	MARÍA;	Bargaining power.	
3	DIEGO;	"Bargaining [power] with his mother."	
4	PEDRO;	[Bargaining].	
5	MARÍA;	What's ["bargaining power"]?	
6	PEDRO;	[We're going on-]We're going on strike. Strike!	Moving arm up and down  *Figure 11*
7	PEDRO;	Diego doesn't pay us enough. [He only pays us five—Five pennies a day].	Pointing fist toward Diego
8	VANESSA;	[Um, like saying],	
9	MARÍA;	Is that related to bargaining power? Is that what you're saying?	
10	PEDRO;	Strike. [We're going on strike]. We're going on strike. Strike. Strike.	Raises arm; repeatedly moves arm up and down *Figure 12*
11	VANESSA;	[Like saying that], since he didn't get anything,	
12	MARÍA;	So he can negotiate with her, Right? [Now he has the power to ask her for something].	
13	DIEGO;	[How much do you want now]?	

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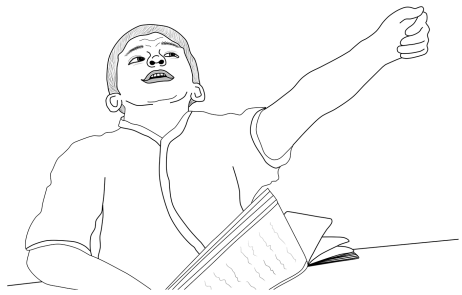
14	PEDRO;	Twelve dollars. Per day. Per day. Per- per week.	Extends arm upwards; strained facial expression  *Figure 13*
15	DIEGO;		Shakes head

Much as she did in the previous example, Vanessa orients to the question by drawing on the specific context and details in the text. She begins to explain that because Jess had not received new clothes like his sisters earlier in the story, he was now in a position to ask his mother for a favor (line 11). In contrast, Pedro is quick to respond to the term by raising his arm and chanting "We're on strike. Strike!" (line 6). Pedro's closed fist and repeated vertical arm movement is a gesture that is emblematic of strikes and of larger social movements and resignifies the term in the context of the discussion through his multimodal performance (Kontovourki & Siegel, 2021). In addition to foregrounding embodied action, Pedro's interpretation of the term is rooted in a more politicized understanding of "bargaining power" characterized by the unequal relationship between workers and their employers. He expands on his definition by incorporating Diego into his enactment of "bargaining power" as the employer who refuses to increase his wages (lines 7, 10–14). Pedro's arm movements and facial expressions become more distressed as he attempts to negotiate his salary by first asking Diego for twelve dollars "per day" and then lowering his request to twelve dollars "per week" (line 14). His movements transition from the more stoic and mechanical representation of a strike to embodying a sense of desperation through his extended arm and strained facial expression as he grasps for something above him and out of reach. This enactment of a worker on strike and "displacement" from the original narrative (Heller, 2019) also functions as an invitation for his peers to engage with an alternative storyline and point of view. In addition, Pedro's "spontaneous dramatization" of the term, while not explicitly connected to the storyline, communicates his "expressive engagement" (Sipe, 2002) and participation in the text, as well as expanding the possible literary responses available to others in this shared space.

Classroom 3: Critical Embodied Argumentation in an 11th-Grade Reading Class for "Newcomers"

The interaction below took place during the introductory lesson to a unit on Gender and Sexuality in Ms. Aviva's eleventh-grade Reading class at Cedar International High School, a small public high school designed to exclusively serve recently arrived multilingual immigrant youth who are often referred to as "newcomers." This dataset was gathered in 2019 as part of a larger study exploring peer interaction among multilingual immigrant students in four classrooms. Nora (Author 3), who identifies as a middle-class, White, bilingual woman, conducted weekly visits in each classroom over the course of 7 months and actively engaged with students as they navigated literacy activities. Ms. Aviva's Reading class included youth from Guatemala, Honduras, Mexico, Colombia, Pakistan, Burma, China, Vietnam, Eritrea, and Afghanistan who spoke Spanish, Mam, Urdu, Burmese, Mandarin, Vietnamese, Amharic, and Farsi at home, and whose educational backgrounds and experiences using English varied widely. While a few students had arrived and enrolled in US schools for the first time the year that data were collected, the majority of the students in this class were in the midst of their third year attending US schools. Although the class regularly included lessons explicitly focused on target linguistic forms and the development of discrete "literacy skills," Ms. Aviva, who identified as a queer Jewish woman, had considerable flexibility concerning curriculum design and had created the course around thematic units addressing what she described as "social justice issues," including Religion, Disabilities, Community, and Gender and Sexuality. In part because the students' educational and language backgrounds varied widely, Ms. Aviva regularly facilitated literacy activities that called on students to engage with

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multimodal resources, including videos, digital and still images, and their own drawings. Consistent with the school's approach to language, literacy, and content learning, she consistently encouraged students to leverage their multilingualism, and a substantial portion of classroom activities were conducted in small groups.

Prior to the interaction below, Ms. Aviva provided table groups of four or five students with a set of images and written texts relevant to the article students would be reading. The set included photographs of a lighter, a city bus, a group of students protesting, a "juvenile correctional center," a high school campus, a skirt, and two short excerpts from the text. Ms. Aviva explained that students had 6 minutes to use the images and quotations provided to make a prediction, as a group, about the focal text. She instructed students to write their prediction on the small whiteboard at their tables, adding that they should begin with the phrase "We predict the article will be about. .." The focal text itself (which students read later that class period) was an adapted version of a New York Times article that described an act of violence against a student who identified as genderqueer on a California city bus in 2013, and how the young Black male student who had committed the act was positioned by the police and media. In the below examples, Nicanor, Esmat, Labibah, and Jéssica–all of whom are racialized multilingual students–worked together to formulate their prediction. Nicanor and Jéssica, who had grown up in Guatemala and Mexico, respectively, were both Spanish speakers, though Nicanor also spoke Mam, an indigenous language of Guatemala at home. Labibah, who is from Pakistan, spoke Urdu at home. Esmat, who appears little in the interaction below, is a Farsi speaker from Afghanistan.

Notably, a number of the constraints that we describe above were somewhat less evident in this interaction. Unlike the previous examples in which a teacher or researcher was actively involved in guiding students' engagement with the text and physically monitoring their actions, in this case, the students negotiated the literacy activity without direct involvement from an adult. While students were not explicitly instructed to move the images into order, this activity, like many others in this classroom, also created opportunities for students to participate in embodied ways, thereby suggesting a view of literacy that is not entirely logocentric. Additionally, this example differs from the examples from Classroom 1 and 2 in that the text students would be engaging with was explicitly positioned as addressing aspects of social identities, and Ms. Aviva underscored that students' distinct perspectives and experiences would shape their sense-making surrounding the topic of gender and sexuality. She did not, at least while the researcher was present, address the role of racialized identities of the young people described in the article, nor students' own racialized identities in relation to this text. In the example below, we demonstrate how–even in the context of a literacy task that intentionally provided opportunities for embodied participation, positioned students as agents, and allowed for more extended discourse–students expanded on the task through their embodied argumentation and were simultaneously constrained by dominant ideologies.

Excerpt 6

13	LABIBAH;	This is the mistake he made, this is the boy that he burned, and this is how he burned, this is where he burned the boy, and this is why he burned the boy, and this is where=	Moves an image into the sequence each time she says "this" while Jéssica and Nicanor simultaneously move images
14	JÉSSICA;	=In the bus	Slides image of the bus up in line
15	LABIBAH;	In the bus @@ And that's the country	Reaches across the table, pointing to another image *Figure 14*
16	JÉSSICA;	This is- he burned the boy because he was wearing a skirt (1.5) on the bus [and]	Taps images, pauses looking at last image

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17	LABIBAH;	[In the] United States (1.0) it comes up because=	Points to the top of the sequence of images
18	JÉSSICA;	=And then he go to the center- young correctional center	Ignores Labibah's suggestion, places image at the bottom of sequence
19	NICANOR;		Reaches across to pick up a quotation from the text *Figure 15*

Above, Jéssica, Labibah, and Nicanor's joint attention to the images themselves and the embodied action of moving the images acted as substantive contributions to the analytical work of making a prediction. In some instances, students' embodied actions with the material resources functioned alone, while in others, these actions functioned in concert with verbal contributions, as in the case of Labibah and Jessica's actions in lines 13–17. Labibah pairs deictic gestures with specific demonstratives "THIS" and "that" as she moves the images in lines 13, 15, and 17. As Norris (2002) explains, the use of demonstratives assumes that the listener understands what the speaker is referring to. Indeed, Labibah's verbal description, "This is the mistake he made, this is the boy that he burned, and this is how he burned, this is where he burned the boy, and this is why he burned the boy, and this is where," would have made little sense to her group members without the corresponding deictic gestures of pointing to each image or excerpt as she spoke.

As they engaged in the prediction activity, Labibah, Jéssica, and Nicanor co-constructed epistemic stance displays in ways that were at times collaborative and, at others, confrontational (Heller, 2018). For instance, beginning in line 13, Labibah initiates the movement and ordering of the images. In doing so, she adopts an epistemically authoritative stance as the most knowledgeable group member about the events described in the article by simultaneously framing her verbal contribution as an assertion, physically moving the images to match the order of events she is suggesting and gazing downward toward the images. Collectively, these actions allowed her, at least temporarily, to avoid potential contestation from the other group members. In the turns that follow, Jéssica and Labibah vie for epistemic authority, as evidenced by their embodied assertions (relocating the images in lines 13, 14, 18), deictic gestures (e.g., pointing to or tapping on an image for emphasis in lines 17, 18, 19), and their verbal contributions framed as statements of fact (e.g., lines 13–18). While Nicanor has said nothing throughout this exchange, attention to his embodied actions (e.g., leaning in and gazing toward the images) reveals his invested stance. Rather than positioning himself as an authority, however, his physical posture and movement of the images contribute to framing the activity as collaborative. In line 19, Nicanor reaches across Labibah to the slip of paper with a quotation from the text that has yet to be addressed in the group's prediction. In doing so, he orients to expectations for the literacy task as it has been presented by the teacher and ostensibly invites the group to discuss, "How does this piece fit in?" Jéssica and Labibah ratify Nicanor's move to discuss the quotation, yet, as we illustrate below, they continue to negotiate epistemic authority.

Excerpt 7 demonstrates how students' embodied interaction surrounding the carceral system challenged their epistemic authority relative to one another, the confines of the literacy task, and dominant ideologies surrounding criminal justice. Through embodied argumentation, students create opportunities for the co-construction of knowledge as they negotiate disparate perspectives (Heller, 2021). In this example, the movement of images, in conjunction with body positioning, gaze, and verbal contributions, acted as resources as the students debated their collective prediction. At the same time, their disagreement over the physical order of the images points to disparate perspectives on the logic and enactment of the carceral system–a debate that extends far beyond the confines of the task as it had been presented to them and one that is arguably far more challenging.

In this example, their embodied argumentation progresses from how to complete the literacy task to a more complex negotiation around notions of justice. In line 20, Labibah picks up the image of a juvenile detention center, looks up at Jéssica, and asks, "This is jail?". Following

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Excerpt 7

20	LABIBAH;	This is jail?	Picks up the image of a juvenile detention center, looks up at Jéssica
21	NICANOR;		Leans toward Labibah to see image
22	JÉSSICA;	Yeah, it's kind of jail for the young people	Curls index and middle finger making quotation marks as she says "young people"
23	NICANOR;		Looks up at Jéssica
24	LABIBAH;		Picks up the image of the juvenile detention center and looks at it closely
25	NICANOR;		Leans over to view image that Labibah is holding
26	LABIBAH;	How do you know?	
27	NICANOR;		Takes the image out of Labibah's hand to look at it more closely
28	LABIBAH;		Leans toward Nicanor and holds on to the edge of the image
29	JÉSSICA;	Because it say that right there!	Reaches over and points to the words "juvenile correctional center" on the building in the image that Nicanor and Labibah are each holding with one hand
30	NICANOR;	*No, pero es para* "young" {No, but it's for "young"}	Slides image out of Labibah's hand to examine more closely *Figure 16*
31	JÉSSICA;	*Por eso!* {That's why!}	
32	NICANOR;	*Esto va por allí primero, no?* {This goes over there first, no?}	Moves the image of the detention center to the top of the sequence without setting it down and then hands it to Jéssica *Figure 17*

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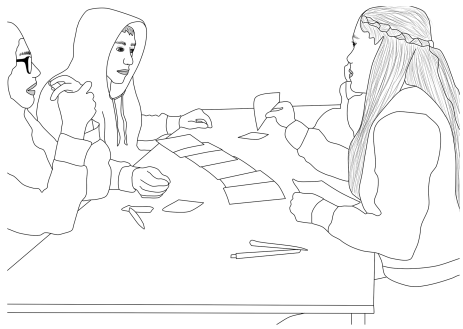
33	JÉSSICA;	*No, ese es cuando ya- cuando haces algo. No te meten primero en la cárcel antes de hacer un-algo.* {No, that is when already-when you do something. They don't put you first in jail before doing a- something}	Shakes image of the detention center in hand in front of Nicanor and Labibah  *Figure 18*
34	NICANOR;	*Ohh.* (1.0) *Primero te meten!* {Ohh. First they put you in!}	Nods once, then shakes head and contests Jéssica's statement
35	JÉSSICA;	*No::! Primero pasa* = {No! First comes}	
36	NICANOR;	=*Pero sólo como tres días o dos días* {But just like 3 days or 2 days}	Holds up three and then two fingers
37	JÉSSICA;	*Sí, pero ya después de que hicistes algo. Por ejemplo, yo que no he hecho nada? Por un ejemplo, no me van a llevar a la cárcel nada más así? Y después voy a hacer las cosas, verdad? No.* {Yeah, but after you already did something. For example, I haven't done anything, for an example, they aren't going to bring me straight to jail just like that? And afterward I'm going to do the things, right? No.}	Waves the image in left hand *Figure 19*

Jéssica's confirmation, "Yeah, it's kind of jail for the young people" (line 22), Labibah challenges Jéssica's authority. Labibah looks closely at the image she is holding, presumably searching for visual evidence of this claim, and then looks up at Jéssica to ask, "How do you know?" (line 26). Jéssica responds emphatically, "Because it say that right there!" (line 29), both reasserting her position as knowledgeable and pointing to evidence in the text to support her claim. While Nicanor's gaze, body positioning, and physical manipulation of the images demonstrate his investment throughout this interaction, he adopts a more authoritative stance than he had in thus far during the interaction when the group discusses the image of a juvenile detention center. He also challenges the dominant discourse (consistent with that put forth by Jéssica) that the carceral system follows a predictable, linear, and just logic. In line 27, Nicanor adopts a more epistemically authoritative stance and heightens his stance of investment in the debate as he slips the image of the juvenile justice facility out of Labibah's hands and looks at it closely. Continuing to position himself somewhat authoritatively, in 32, Nicanor suggests, *"Esto va por allí primero, no*?"{This goes over there first, no?} as he moves the image of the detention center to the top of the sequence. Through this gestalt of actions, he is potentially proposing that the young man in the text was incarcerated at the beginning of this story rather than the end, as Jéssica would argue. Unlike most of Jéssica and Labibah's contributions, Nicanor frames his proposal as a question and allows Jéssica to take the image from his hand and reject the suggestion (line 32). It is also worth noting that Nicanor leverages Spanish language resources as he engages in this interaction, potentially as part of his investment in the interaction and authoritative stance-taking. The shift to Spanish also directly invites a response from Jéssica, the only other Spanish speaker in the group. Jéssica responds emphatically and authoritatively with an explanation consistent with the dominant narrative that only those who have committed a crime are arrested or incarcerated: "*No, ese es cuando ya- cuando haces algo? No te meten primero en la carcel antes de hacer un-algo*" {No, that is when already-when you do something? They don't put you first in jail before doing a- something} while simultaneously shaking the image in front of Nicanor (line 33).

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Nicanor and Jéssica continue to argue back and forth in lines 34–36, multimodally contesting each other's interpretations of the order of events when a person is incarcerated. In line 34, Nicanor initially nods in agreement but then rejects Jéssica's assertion that someone would not be jailed before having committed a crime, arguing "*Primero te meten!*" {First they put you in!} and then adding "*pero sólo como tres días o dos días*." {but just like 3 days or 2 days}.

Nicanor's insistence that people are often arrested without having committed a crime or before having been tried for a crime (which he communicates through a multimodal gestalt in which he moves the images and asserts this stance verbally, in Spanish) potentially reflects his own understanding of the degree of justice afforded by this system. Jéssica, in contrast, insists that someone is only jailed "*después de que hicistes algo. Por ejemplo, yo que no he hecho nada? Por un ejemplo, no me van a llevar a la cárcel nada más así? Y después voy a hacer las cosas, verdad? No.*" {Yeah, but after you already did something. For example, I haven't done anything, for an example, they aren't going to bring me straight to jail just like that? And afterward I'm going to do the things, right? No.} (line 37). It is particularly noteworthy that Jéssica begins this statement with the second person (*después de que hicistes algo*) and then shifts to the first person (*Por ejemplo, yo que no he hecho nada?.. .*) In doing so, she invites Nicanor into an "imagined scenario" (Heller, 2021) in which *she* herself is arrested. She also reaffirms an authoritative stance, first framing this imagined scenario as a question but then quickly stating the answer as she sees it: "*no me van a llevar a la cárcel nada más así? Y después voy a hacer las cosas, verdad? No.*" In shifting to the first person and proposing what might happen in the case of her own hypothetical arrest, Jéssica both claims epistemic authority and conveys how she makes sense of the events through her own experience as someone racialized in ways different from Nicanor.

Through embodied resources, including deictic gestures, movement of the images, and the establishment of eye contact in conjunction with their verbal contributions, the students display invested and authoritative stances–while simultaneously navigating power dynamics with one another and in relation to broader discourses of performing literacy (Kontovourki & Siegel, 2021). While Labibah, Jéssica, and Nicanor all point to, tap on, and relocate the images, their interaction is also influenced by how they each position themselves and are positioned by one another as literate–and as particular kinds of students. Ethnographic data from fieldnotes and interviews with teachers and students revealed that Jéssica and Labibah were regarded as highly successful students by their peers and their teacher, while Nicanor was sometimes positioned as distracted or disengaged, and was less likely to be sought out by his classmates as a source of knowledge. This epistemic positioning was perhaps due, at least in part, to his degree of experience using English relative to Jéssica and Labibah and to all three students' raciolinguistic and class-based identities. Evidence of these power dynamics is also present within embodied aspects of the interaction. For instance, when Labibah asks, "This is jail?" she looks directly at Jéssica, suggesting that Jéssica is the only group member capable of answering this question. In spite of being positioned by his peers as less knowledgeable, however, Nicanor consistently displays an invested stance in the activity, as evident in the orientation of his body and gaze throughout the interaction. In contrast, Esmat, the fourth group member who was both new to the classroom ecosystem and to the United States, is not directly addressed by any of the group members during this interaction, nor does he physically engage with the materials. The generativity of students' embodied sense-making during this interaction is apparent–as are constraints of the literacy task itself and ecologies of power that impacted the degree to which each of them was positioned as successful literacy learners and students. Far from being "off-task," their creative deployment of a multimodal gestalt as they debate about the carceral system indicates their engagement in literacy practices that, presumably, their teacher is seeking to cultivate. At the same time, their embodied actions also highlight the constraints of both local ecologies and broader power dynamics in which students are situated.

Discussion and Conclusion

In this paper, we have examined the complex multimodal gestalts (Mondada, 2014) through which raciolinguistically minoritized students' embodied agency (Bucholtz & Hall, 2016) becomes especially visible as they navigate a range of constraints during classroom literacy activities. Our analysis offers concrete, interactionally situated examples of how, rather than being a mere supplement to language, embodiment is a nuanced resource that is central to students' critical reading of and engagement with texts—an activity often framed as purely a matter of cognitive interaction. Rather than focusing on the deployment of individual semiotic resources such as gestures or talk, we argue for the value of exploring how students simultaneously mobilize embodied and other semiotic resources, in addition to oral language, in order to more fully capture the complexity of their sense-making with and around text. Across the three classrooms, students used embodied actions within multimodal gestalts in their epistemic stance-taking, embodied affective responses, and embodied forms of argumentation to negotiate and co-construct meaning in critically literate ways. In some of the cases analyzed above, students used multiple semiotic resources in ways that complemented each other and heightened students' investment in their affective and epistemic

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stances. For instance, as the teacher in Classroom 1 facilitated a discussion about "marches" in the second excerpt, Tessa took an epistemically authoritative and affectively invested stance as she paired her statement that there was a "big gap" between White and Black protestors with an iconic hand gesture. Similarly, in Classroom 3 described above, students pointed to, tapped on, and physically moved the images in conjunction with speech to engage in argumentation over interpretations of the text and to challenge dominant discourses. In other cases, students' embodied actions were unaccompanied by contextualizing speech and acted as powerful resources for conveying meanings that went verbally unarticulated, as seen in Vanessa's neutral facial expression throughout interactions in Classroom 2, which served to communicate epistemic authority while disaligning with the boys' performative affective responses and interpretations of the text. Consistent with calls to dismantle deficit narratives about the language practices of linguistically minoritized youth (Wang et al., 2021), we argue that attention to students' embodied agency presents a promising approach that centers how students effectively leverage a range of embodied resources to critically engage with texts and to participate in meaningful learning.

Our analysis also highlights how embodied actions can serve as important interactional resources for introducing alternative and, at times, more critical narratives and interpretations of texts than those encouraged by teachers, tasks, or curricula. For example, Camila's use of the iconic "slash" gesture in Classroom 1 momentarily created an opportunity for a more nuanced and complex discussion of racial identities compared with the discourses highlighted by the teacher's practices. Similarly, in Classroom 2, students' use of manual gestures, such as Pedro's raised fist to illustrate a strike, opened space for an alternative interpretation of the term "bargaining power," acknowledging a broader range of lived experiences than the ones represented in the text. Even in Classroom 3, where the teacher intentionally centered a more politically "sensitive" topic and encouraged a discussion using multimodal resources, students spontaneously expanded possibilities by initiating a nuanced debate about the carceral system and sharing their perspectives on the injustices it may inflict on young people like themselves. These opportunities for more critical discussions are particularly crucial for raciolinguistically minoritized students—even for students who are positioned as more competent or "advanced" within their classrooms (like Camila, Vanessa, Jéssica, and Labibah)—who do not often see their experiences or perspectives reflected in the design of classroom instruction, particularly by their White teachers.

Across the examples discussed, students generated "double-opportunity spaces" (Blum-Kulka et al., 2004) in which they productively engaged with literacy tasks while simultaneously pursuing relational work with their peers. In Classroom 2, for example, the animated discussion on a dog's possible death challenged the types of narrow text-based predictions modeled for students and allowed them to explore possible future events more expansively while simultaneously connecting over their shared affective responses. In a similar vein, in Classroom 1, students' use of embodied resources was central to their legitimation of one another's knowledge and their affiliative displays of affect (Cekaite & Björk-Willén, 2018; Heller, 2019), as exemplified by Daniel's high investment in multimodally ratifying Tessa's knowledge of racial justice protests. In Classroom 3, as Nicanor and Jéssica debated over how the carceral system functions, their verbal contributions paired with physical manipulation of the images facilitated negotiation of disparate perspectives and experiences. Across these examples, students' agentive mobilization of multimodal and embodied resources often allowed them to engage meaningfully with one another, with the texts, and with experiences, interpretations and affects that are often marginalized or outright delegitimated within logocentric, text-centered, White curricula and pedagogies. Thus, students literally and figuratively had a hand in creating the kinds of double-opportunity spaces necessary for literacy learning and relationship building.

Despite the opportunities generated by students' agentive embodied actions, the lack of ratification by adults, particularly in Classrooms 1 and 2, undermined and marginalized these practices. For example, in Classroom 1, where Camila was positioned as an avid reader and academically "advanced," her contribution to the MLK discussion through the "slash" gestalt was only minimally ratified by the teacher. In Classroom 2, students' affective responses were likewise framed as "off-task" by María, who requested students focus on writing their predictions and positioned Vanessa as the more expert peer who had successfully completed the task. It is important to recognize that teachers face their own set of institutional and ideological constraints that shape their ability to transform instruction and diverge from the demands of standards-based curricula and assessments, as exemplified by the CCSS-aligned instructional practices of the teachers in Classrooms 1 and 2. The relative lack of uptake of students' contributions by institutionally authoritative figures (i.e., teachers and researchers) suggests that "leveraging" multimodal and embodied practices is not only a matter of creating opportunities for students to employ a wider range of semiotic resources, but requires challenging conceptualizations of what counts as literacy, as well as the raciolinguistic ideologies that systematically position racialized students' dynamic communicative practices as inherently "non-academic" (see, e.g., Aragón, 2018; Martínez et al., 2017; García & Solorza, 2021). These examples further highlight the false dichotomy, often reinforced by standards-based instruction, between students' perceived competency in "complex" text-based literacy skills, and

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their use of experiential knowledge and dynamic linguistic and multimodal practices as legitimate resources for sense-making (e.g., Aragón, 2022; Flores, 2020; Martínez & Mejía, 2020).

Our analysis has a number of implications for researchers, particularly for language and literacies scholars. Ethnographically informed multimodal analyses such as the one we have presented here contribute to calls for theoretical and methodological approaches that challenge hierarchical views in which language is positioned as the sole or most meaningful semiotic resource deployed in interaction (Bucholtz & Hall, 2016; Lang, 2022; Nevile, 2015). To be sure, many theoretical and methodological approaches to centering the inherent multimodality of interaction are vital to the broader project of unsettling persistent logocentrism, as is dialogue among these approaches. For instance, Conversation Analytic approaches are useful for examining in fine-grained detail the sequential complexities of how young people mobilize a multitude of semiotic resources simultaneously, often with attention to particular interactive and epistemic functions (see, e.g., Heller, 2019), while embodied literacies approaches that draw on new materialism (e.g., Thiel, 2015) can help educators and researchers reconceptualize literacies practices and pedagogies. At the same time, much of this work, like most work on reading and embodied action to date, does not attend to how reading interactions (and other literacies activities) are shaped by power dynamics within the local ecology of the classroom and beyond in the form of broader ideologies and structures (cf. Johnson, 2017; Kyratzis, 2017). Hence, ethnographically and ideologically informed approaches to multimodal discourse analysis, along with theoretical orientations that closely examine the nuances of how students draw on a range of semiotic resources—to not only make sense of texts but also challenge dominant discourses in the context of text, task, and ideological constraints—are invaluable for shedding light on the ways in which young people are already engaging in critical literacy practices. Comparative cross-classroom discourse analyses are particularly illuminating in this regard; as the analyses of the excerpts presented here demonstrate, multimodal engagement in critical literacies is not limited to particular ages or raciolinguistic backgrounds. Rather, students' investment in producing critical readings of texts and contexts is evident among even young students (like the second-grade students in Classroom 1) and raciolinguistically minoritized students (like the former ELD students in Classroom 2 and the newcomer students in Classroom 3), whom dominant developmentalist discourses and raciolinguistic ideologies, respectively, position as incapable of or uninterested in complex discussions.

With regard to implications for classroom practice, we argue that exclusive attention to students' verbal contributions, particularly when paired with close reading pedagogies or other narrowly constrained analyses of texts, are likely to lead teachers to miss the meaningful contributions that students make through nuanced embodied actions, thereby significantly limiting students' opportunities to genuinely grapple with ideas and to challenge dominant discourses as they engage with texts. Instead, we point to the potential for teachers to closely attend to how students multimodally take invested stances, engage in argumentation, and participate in critical literacy practices through their gestures, facial expressions, and mutual embodied engagement with material resources. Far from being irrelevant or "off-task," these embodied actions have the potential to provide insight into how students are making sense of and actively resisting dominant narratives and institutions. Indeed, if, as Heller et al. (2020) point out, multimodality is not just a resource but also (like language) a practice developed through meaningful interaction, teachers need to attend to students' embodied actions in order to better support them in clarifying, extending, and challenging interpretations of texts using an array of resources.

From this perspective, expanding students' opportunities for literacy development involves not only noticing but also actively taking up students' embodied contributions and encouraging them to do so in their interactions with one another. In Excerpt 1, for instance, rather than partially ratifying Camila's multimodal "like slash" gestalt, we envision Ms. Morris inviting Camila to further elaborate or demonstrate her own sense-making, amplifying for the rest of the class both Camila's oral description and the slash gesture, and calling on other students to offer their own interpretations. Similarly, we argue that teachers' attention to students' embodied actions has the potential to shed light on the ways in which students actively draw on their own experiences and expertise as they engage in literacy tasks and draw connections that lead to more nuanced and critical analyses. For example, in Excerpt 5, Pedro's enactment of "bargaining power" and his portrayal of a strike could have led to a departure from close analysis of the text to incorporate Pedro's own experience of collective bargaining. Ehret et al. (2021) contend that, for literacies researchers, "orienting literacy to affect and embodiment awakens senses and practices in critical ways" (p. 416). We maintain that the same holds true for educators.

Alongside these contributions are limitations and questions that represent fruitful avenues for related future research. Because the three larger studies on which the present analysis is based did not focus specifically on embodied action, we were unable to address certain questions about students' and teachers' perspectives and practices related to embodiment. For instance, how do students themselves describe their own embodied actions? How do students and teachers frame the role of embodiment in reading interactions and other literacy practices? How do students, particularly raciolinguistically minoritized students, navigate logocentrism and the

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white perceiving subject's readings of their embodied literacy practices? In addition, future research could examine each of the embodied practices we identify in our analysis in more detail as well as others that did not emerge from our data. Combining such questions with close interactional analyses of students' and teachers' multimodal gestalts within situated literacy activities would contribute to deepening scholarly understandings of the role of embodiment in students' literacy practices and learning opportunities.

Crucially, educators' attention to students' embodied actions is not a matter of developmentalist surveillance that seeks to socialize children and young people into ableist, White, and otherwise normative practices of bodily containment and control (e.g., Liddiard & Slater, 2018; Lupton, 2013), but rather centers on their agency and entails careful attention to their embodied practices. This emphasis on embodied agency is especially important in the context of the rise of the use of disembodied artificial intelligence systems to make consequential decisions about students' embodied interactions (Nathan, 2023) and in a context in which neoliberal governmentality in schooling reinforces deagentialized views of children and young people as quasi-human (Sonu & Benson, 2016). In this context, viewing students' embodied contributions with an eye to their agentive and innovative mobilization of multiple semiotic resources is vital for teachers' ability to make sense of how students resist and transform dominant ideologies as they interact with one another and with texts (Lewis, 2020). In other words, in addition to "looking closely and listening carefully" to the ways in which raciolinguistically minoritized students engage in sophisticated language and literacy practices deemed valuable within curricula like the CCSS (Martínez & Mejía, 2020), we suggest that educators might also benefit from attending to how students' embodied actions both demonstrate and enact critical literacies. Rosa and Flores (2017), building on Toni Morrison's view that racism functions as a "distraction" from structural inequities, maintain that legitimizing these language practices by highlighting their proximity to whiteness will unlikely lead to change. A focus on embodiment, then, has the potential to encourage both researchers and educators to consider and interrogate their own roles as perceiving subjects of students' critical literacy practices. As Oliveira and Barnes (2019) argue, these critical literacy practices include expanding beyond the text itself and challenging the passive, transmissive reader stances (Rosenblatt, 1978) often socialized in mainstream literacy education. And as demonstrated by analyses like the one we have presented here, these overall reader stances are communicated not only by curricular policies or by teachers' practices, but rather are constructed through students' moment-by-moment multimodal stances. It is through these fleeting stances that students provide windows into their complex sense-making and assert their literate identities as the kinds of critical readers needed to build a more socially just society.

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Conflict of Interest Statement

The authors declare no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, and/or publication of this article.

NOTES

[1] Throughout this article we also use the term "raciolinguistically minoritized" to foreground the role of the co-naturalization of language and race in how students are positioned within existing social categories and structures (see Rosa & Flores, 2017).

[2] It should be noted that this sociocultural view of stance as interactionally emergent differs from the more pedagogical concept of "reader stance" (Rosenblatt, 1978; see also Oliveira & Barnes, 2019) that has been influential in much literacies research. However, our analyses have implications for the kinds of reader stances students are ultimately encouraged to develop, a point to which we return in the Discussion and Conclusion section.

[3] There is considerable overlap among the notions of a complex multimodal gestalt, lamination of layers of semiotic fields (Goodwin and Cekaite, 2013), and semiotic assemblages (Pennycook, 2017), all of which emphasize that interaction always involves the mobilization of a range of semiotic resources and is inherently situated within the context of the particular activity.

[4] To protect participants' identities, we regrettably cannot further specify some participants' ethnoracial backgrounds. Other participants' ethnoracial identities are described in more specific terms where doing so does not pose a risk of identification.

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María José Aragón (corresponding author) is an Assistant Professor, Department of Education Studies, University of California, San Diego, San Diego, CA, USA; email: mjaragon@ucsd.edu.

Meghan Corella is an Assistant Professor, Department of Language & Literacy Education, Faculty of Education, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada; email: meghan.corella@ubc.ca.

Nora W. Lang is a Lecturer, Department of Teacher Education, San José State University, San Jose, California, USA; email: nora.lang@sjsu.edu.

APPENDIX A

The following conventions have been adapted from Bucholtz et al. (2012).

;	Speaker attribution
.	Terminative intonation
,	Continuative intonation
?	Rising intonation
!	Raised pitch and volume
:	Prosodic lengthening
-	Self-interruption
=	Latching; no pause between intonation units
@	Laughter (each token marks one pulse)
(.)	Pause of less than 0.5 seconds
(1.5)	Measured pause of 0.5 seconds or more
[]	Overlapping speech
< >	Analyst comment on utterance quality
(())	Analyst description of embodied action
#	Unintelligible syllable
#word	Uncertain word
word	Emphatic stress
words	Spanish utterances
{words}	English translations of Spanish utterances

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